# SpeechGeek



## Season Eight: Winter 2011

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# Season Eight: Winter 2011

**SpeechGeek**
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**Corey Alderdice**
Editor and Publisher

Email:
thegeek@speechgeek.com

806 Brownstone Way
Bowling Green, KY 42104
(270) 705-3632

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The Geek and Mrs. Geek have had a busy two months since the release of our Season Eight: Fall 2010 issue.

You see, we welcomed the newest forensicator to our family: Elliott. He may only be eight weeks old, but it seems that he already has the booming voice and screaming of a future Dramatic Interp all-star.

Based on the way I smile when I see him, maybe he'd be better suited for H.I. rounds?

Maybe he won't even like forensics--though I highly doubt that.

While every season is a new adventure, this one has been even more so around the SpeechGeek HQ. Becuase of our new addition, this second issue wraps Season Eight.

Don't worry, though, as there's still a lot of great stuff in store for you before Nationals 2011 in Dallas!

**Corey Alderdice**
**Publisher**

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SpeechGeek

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# Hypothetically Yours

***by Katie Newport***

*(Brian knocks on door, and Jeremy answers it.)*

**BRIAN.** Hey, Jeremy.

**JEREMY.** Hey, Brian. Linda's not here right now... She should be back in maybe ten, fifteen minutes if you wanted to come back then.

**BRIAN.** *(lets himself in)* It's fine, I'll just wait here. I needed to talk to you, anyway.

**JEREMY.** *(closes door after a beat)* Sorry, but I'm actually kind of busy. I've got a lot of--

**BRIAN.** *(not paying attention)* Jeremy, can I ask you a question?

**JEREMY.** No.

**BRIAN.** Because I.... Wait. What?

**JEREMY.** No, you may not ask me a question.

**BRIAN.** But... Why not? I really need your help.

**JEREMY.** I'm sorry, but I cannot allow myself to "help" you again. You know what happened last time.

**BRIAN.** Oh, come on, Jeremy. We've known each other since high school, before I even started dating your sister. You can't let one little thing-

**JEREMY.** One little thing? That's a bit of an understatement, don't you think?

**BRIAN.** You're making this a bigger deal than it needs to be. I mean, that was so long ago that I can barely even remember what happened.

**JEREMY.** Oh? Let me take you back about two-and-a-half years ago. The location: this very living room.

**BRIAN.** Jeremy-

**JEREMY.** I was all dressed up, getting ready for a date. Then you suddenly burst through the door, begging for help and advice.

**BRIAN.** Are you done now?

**JEREMY.** *(ignoring him)* Jeremy! I need your help and advice! I want to take Linda to Hawaii for our five-year anniversary—did you know it's been five years since we started dating?--but I can't decide on the best mode of transportation and it is only four months away! Should I buy plane tickets or would a cruise be better?' Then we pro ceeded to go through what could hypothetically happen in each situation.

**BRIAN.** You can't possibly be blaming that on me.

**JEREMY.** Long story short, we ended up hypothetically stranded on a hypothetical island where, hypothetically, there was no food. This was, of course, after our hypothetical plane hypothetically crashed due to the hypothetical bird that flew into the hypothetical engine.

**BRIAN.** Jeremy! That was ages ago. And nothing that bad actually hap pened--

**JEREMY.** Brian, my date was ticked because I was late to pick her up.

Because of this, we didn't do anything… At all. Oh, and remember? You ate my tie.

**BRIAN.** I was starving… hypothetically…

**JEREMY.** That was my favorite lime green tie!

**BRIAN.** Well, if it makes you feel better, it didn't really taste like limes…

**JEREMY.** Goodbye, Brian. *(goes to push him out the door)*

**BRIAN.** *(ignoring him)* Listen, Jeremy. I need to know the best way to prop--

**JEREMY.** You're not going to leave unless I help, are you?

**BRIAN.** Nope. I need some hypothetical advice.

**JEREMY.** *(With a sigh, he mimes checking his cell phone. He stares at it for a minute, then flops down onto the couch.)* Fine. What is it?

**BRIAN.** When you love someone… I mean, when two people love each other very much, hypothetically, of course… Is it too old-fashioned for the man to get down on his knees when he… *(gives Jeremy a knowing look)* you know?

**JEREMY.** ……What?! Brian, that's my sister you're talking about! What do you think you're doing? I don't want to know about what you two do or don't do… old fashioned, or on your knees, or traditionally, or handcuffed, or like that video you rented, or-

**BRIAN.** Whoa, whoa, whoa. I thought we promised to never bring that up again--

**JEREMY.** You're the one who-

**BRIAN.** I was talking about PROPOSING. I want to PROPOSE to Linda!

**JEREMY.** Oh… I guess that's better.

**BRIAN.** But I can't decide what would be the most romantic way to do it. Since you are her brother and my friend, I wanted your opinion.

**JEREMY.** Do you have any ideas?

**BRIAN.** *(proud of himself)* I've narrowed it down to four: skydiving, canoe ing, a walk along the beach, or bowling.

**JEREMY.** … Bowling?

**BRIAN.** Bowling.

**JEREMY.** How is bowling romantic?

**BRIAN.** Are you kidding me? I can see it now… Linda and I, walking out after I've bowled a perfect 300, and I get down on my knee in the parking lot and ask her to marry me. She starts openly weeping and, through her tears, she says, "Yes! Yes! A thousand times yes!"

**JEREMY.** Want to know what would actually happen?

**BRIAN.** *(coming out of his daydream)* Huh?

**JEREMY.** You and Linda will walk out of the bowling alley. You're still bitter about missing your best score of 70 by one pin. Then you get down on one knee amidst a pile of used syringes… God only knows what diseases you'll contract… And then you grab her hand and ask her to marry you. The only problem is that your voice is drowned out by the bang of a gunshot and the nearing police sirens. Yeah. Real romantic.

**BRIAN.** So is that a no to bowling…?



**JEREMY.** *(stares at him for a long moment and pushes him to door)* Goodbye, Brian.

**BRIAN.** Okay, okay. Skydiving? How about skydiving?

**JEREMY.** I guess it can't be any worse than the bowling.

**BRIAN.** All right. Let's try role-playing. I'll be Linda, and you be me.

**JEREMY.** *(patronizingly)* No. I'll be Linda, you be you. Okay?

**BRIAN.** Oh… That makes more sense.

**JEREMY.** Okay, where do you want to start… Honey?

**BRIAN.** Let's start on the plane.

**JEREMY.** *(begin speaking in a falsetto voice)* Okay, Darling.

**BRIAN.** Are you ready to jump?

**JEREMY.** Buttercup! Do you WANT me to die? I don't have a parachute on yet!

**BRIAN.** *(alarmed)* Okay, so now that you do have a parachute, I'll jump first, and then-

**JEREMY.** Oh, of course. That's fine. You always have to put yourself first, don't you? What about me? What about MY needs?!

**BRIAN.** Do you want to go first?

**JEREMY.** Sure, Muffincakes.

**BRIAN.** Okay, so--

**JEREMY.** Let me get this straight, Cuddlecake. You want me to jump out of a moving plane so you can fly off into the sunset with some floozy you have stashed on board?!

**BRIAN.** What?!

**JEREMY.** WHERE IS SHE?

**BRIAN.** Jeremy, I--

**JEREMY.** JEREMY?! You're leaving me for a MAN?!

**BRIAN.** JEREMY!

**JEREMY.** Who is Jeremy?!?

**BRIAN.** Get a hold of yourself, man! *(Brian slaps Jeremy)*

**JEREMY.** *(shaking it off)* Oh, sorry.

**BRIAN.** We'll jump together.

*(BOTH mime jumping out of plane.)*

**JEREMY.** *(High pitched scream, suddenly hugs Brian tightly)*

**BRIAN.** Jere- I mean, Linda! What's wrong, Snugglebunny?

**JEREMY.** I'm afraid of heights, Choochielips!

**BRIAN.** …Linda's favorite hobby is mountain climbing, Jeremy. You are the one who has to get your next door neighbor to change your light bulbs because you're too afraid to get on a step ladder.

**JEREMY.** Oh, yeah.

**BRIAN.** So we jump together. *(next lines said in unison, Brian mystified and Jeremy sarcastic)* And then our chutes will deploy at the same time, and it will be magical…

**JEREMY.** And then our chutes will deploy at the same time, and then they will tangle together and we'll spiral down to our deaths like a morbid double helix.

**BRIAN.** Oh… That's a terrible idea! How about I jump first and I propose in the air?

**JEREMY.** Well… I'm not sure how committed I am to this relationship… I don't know if I want to be tied down, you know? And what if I say no?

**BRIAN.** Oh, God…

**JEREMY.** You'd have the entire way down to think about how completely stupid you are…

**BRIAN.** *(devastated)* Oh, God! What if she does say no?! What if she doesn't love me?

**JEREMY.** You'll never know unless you ask.

**BRIAN.** You're right. Okay, okay… Next hypothetical scenario: canoeing. I'll take her to *el Lago de Cacahuate*--

**JEREMY.** You're taking her to Peanut Lake?

**BRIAN.** It sounds more romantic when you say it in Spanish. Anyway, I'll take her there and we'll get in our canoe. We'll go out to the middle of the lake, go fishing, and have a picnic in our canoe. Then maybe we'll dance… in the canoe. Like in the movies, you know?

**JEREMY.** Okay, so you'll take her to Peanut Lake. *(long pause)* You do realize that JIF dumps chemical waste into the lake, right? So you're not even going to be able to row anywhere because of the sludge. Then, if you somehow did manage to get to the middle of the lake, all the fish are already dead. And you know that the fumes from that chemical waste can give small children asthma, so it's not exactly going to be easy to eat lunch. And nobody dances in canoes. What kind of movies are you watching? Besides, can either of you swim?

**BRIAN.** Umm, well--

**JEREMY.** No? That's what I thought.

**BRIAN.** *(contemplative pause)* So is that a 'maybe' to canoeing?

**JEREMY.** Brian…

**BRIAN.** All right, fine. So that just leaves… *(pauses hesitantly, afraid of Jeremy's reaction)* a walk along the beach?

**JEREMY.** Hmm… Well, I guess that could work.

**BRIAN.** But I-- wait. Really?

**JEREMY.** Yeah. It has more potential than any of the other options, anyways. Although…

**BRIAN.** *(groans)*

**JEREMY.** Well, come on. A walk along the beach is a little bit cliché, don't you think?

**BRIAN.** I guess… But it seemed so romantic that I-

**JEREMY.** *(ignoring him again)* Definitely too cliché. It needs to be more unique, more interesting. How about… horses!

**BRIAN.** Horses?

**JEREMY.** Yes! A horse-back ride along the beach! I can picture it now: a pair of white horses galloping majestically along the shoreline as the sun shimmers across the waves, and then you--



**BRIAN.** Hold on! Where in the world am I supposed to get horses?

**JEREMY.** That's not my problem. My job is to sit here and keep you distracted by crushing your fanciful dreams with my own fanciful imaginings.

**BRIAN.** … Wait, what?

**JEREMY.** What? Anyway. Horses. Go.

**BRIAN.** But I… Okay. *(shifting into hypothetical situation mode)* Linda my love, isn't the sunset magical?

**JEREMY.** *(begins clapping to make the sound of horses galloping)* What?

**BRIAN.** Um… I said, isn't the sunset magical? I… Listen, Linda. We've been dating for a long time and… I love you very much, and… I would like… What are you doing?

**JEREMY.** *(stops clapping, frustrated)* You have to be able to talk over the sounds of the horses. What happens if she can't hear your heartfelt profession of love? Then you'll be sitting there awkwardly waiting for a response while she wonders why you're so quiet. *(Jeremy begins clapping once more, but Brian quickly grabs his hands to silence them.)*

**BRIAN.** Enough! I slowed the horses to a stop, and now we're sitting next to each other, staring into each other's eyes.

**JEREMY.** *(mimicking Linda's voice again)* Oh, Brian…

**BRIAN.** Oh, Linda… I have loved you since the moment I first laid eyes upon you. Will you m--

**JEREMY.** *(loud, obnoxious sneeze to cut him off)*

**BRIAN.** Really?!

**JEREMY.** Sorry…

**BRIAN.** What was that?!

**JEREMY.** I'm allergic to horses.

**BRIAN.** *(staring at him incredulously for a long moment)* Jeremy. They are hypothetical horses. They. Aren't. REAL.

**JEREMY.** Oh, so you can suffer from hypothetical starvation but I'm not allowed to suffer from hypothetical allergies?

**BRIAN.** Jeremy! This is SERIOUS. Take some hypothetical Benadryl and then FOCUS.

**JEREMY.** *(huffily)* Fine.

**BRIAN.** Linda, you are the love of my life. I feel as if I've known you for forever, and I want to be with you for forever. Will you marry me?

**JEREMY.** No.

**BRIAN.** … No?

**JEREMY.** Nope.

**BRIAN.** Are you serious?

**JEREMY.** Yep.

**BRIAN.** But… But why? Why not? We've been dating for nearly eight years. I know you better than I know my family members, and we… I… I love you, Linda! So why won't you marry me?

**JEREMY.** *(back to himself)* Brian, have you ever considered that Linda doesn't love you back?

**BRIAN.** What?!

**JEREMY.** That maybe she's just dating you out of pity? She feels bad for you, so she can't break up with you?

**BRIAN.** But… I…

**JEREMY.** Or maybe she only wants you for your money? You're a pretty well off guy, and you buy her lots of pretty presents.

**BRIAN.** But I thought we--

**JEREMY.** Or maybe she has another boyfriend, and she is just using you?

**BRIAN.** *(weakly)* Well…

**JEREMY.** *(brief pause)* Or maybe she is sick and tired of waiting for seven and a half years for you to propose. Maybe she saw you coming into our house and texted me to keep you distracted for about ten minutes while she got ready for your date later. Maybe she plans on proposing to you, since you took too long. And maybe that box over there under the table is a present that she planned on giving you.

**BRIAN.** I… Wait… Huh? Is she really… What kind of present?

**JEREMY.** *(standing up and walking towards the door)* A parachute. *(opens door)* Bye, Brian.



# Chasing Snowflakes

***by Katie Newport***

*(It is the one-year anniversary of the first time Michael and Anna met. They are spending it at Anna's apartment, sitting next to each other on her couch. They sit together for a long moment, enjoying each other's presence. She leans her head on his shoulder.)*

**ANNA.** You know what I love?

**MICHAEL.** (*He glances at her quickly, surprised.)* What's that?

**ANNA.** (*She stands and walks to the window; he watches her, confused.)* Snow. When it snows, everything just seems so quiet, you know? It's like the whole world is holding its breath, waiting for… something.

**MICHAEL.** *(He laughs weakly to himself, then looks back at her.)* I know what you mean.

**ANNA.** Really, though… If anything in this world could be considered magic, it'd be snow.

**MICHAEL.** *(He frowns in confusion again, but he cannot help but laugh at the dreamy tone in her voice. He stands and walks over to her, wrap ping his arms around her waist.)* Really? Of all the things in the world, you would choose a type of precipitation within the Earth's atmosphere in the form of crystalline water ice as being "magical?"

**ANNA.** *(She shakes him off, frowning.)* You are such a jerk sometimes. Don't go all science-y on me. You know what I'm talking about.

**MICHAEL.** I'm not sure that I do.

**ANNA.** Just look at snowflakes! They're so tiny, but if you really look at them they're… intricate, and beautiful. But all that detail can disappear in an instant and you might not even get a chance to see it.

**MICHAEL.** *(frowning again)* That sounds more depressing than magical.

**ANNA.** Oh, come on. It's like… It's like your whole life could change in that instant while you're frozen inside a glittery wonderland. Snow makes wonderful things happen, you just have to watch so you don't miss them.

**MICHAEL.** I think you're giving it more credit than it deserves.

**ANNA.** Am I? The first time we met was because of the snow.

**MICHAEL.** Well, yes.

**ANNA.** And our first date was during a snowstorm that was almost as bad as this one.

**MICHAEL.** I suppose you're right, but-

**ANNA.** *(She looks up at him, grinning.)* Do you remember that? We almost killed ourselves driving to the movie theater.

**MICHAEL.** (*grinning back at her)* And then by the time we got there, the storm had knocked out the power.

**ANNA.** *(laughing)* And then we almost killed ourselves driving back to my apartment, chasing snowflakes.

**MICHAEL.** I have to say, that was probably the best cup of hot chocolate I've had in my life.

**ANNA.** Exactly! (n*ow acting haughty, but still teasing)* That was a pity date, you know. If it hadn't been for the snow, I might not have gotten to know you well enough to say yes to a second date.

**MICHAEL.** Are you really going to credit all of that to the snow?

**ANNA.** Fine, you're right. I didn't like you just because of the snow.

**MICHAEL.** *(smugly)* Thank you.

**ANNA.** The hot chocolate helped a lot, too.

**MICHAEL.** You are hopeless.

**ANNA.** Hey, in my mind, that date was made perfect by snow, which proves that snow makes wonderful things happen!

**MICHAEL.** I still don't think you can-

**ANNA.** And if you don't think that date was wonderful, then you might as well leave.

**MICHAEL.** *(She was only teasing, but he is hurt by her words.)* I do think those things are wonderful. More than wonderful.

**ANNA.** As you should.

(*They both laugh, then go to sit back on the couch.)*

**ANNA.** You're pretty whipped, you know.

**MICHAEL.** *(He bursts out laughing, offended but knowing that she's not totally wrong.)* Hey, now. Just because I… *(He hesitates, then changes his mind on what he was going to say.)* I don't want to hurt your feelings, doesn't mean that I'm whipped.

**ANNA.** *(She smirks in response, but does not argue.)*

**MICHAEL.** *(After a moment, he stands.)* All this talk of hot chocolate—

**ANNA.** The container of hot chocolate mix is in the third cabinet from the right in the kitchen. The marshmallows should be next to it.

**MICHAEL.** *(laughing and walking off towards the kitchen)*

**ANNA.** *(addressing the audience)* You know, I wasn't totally kidding. I only went on that date with him because my friends forced me too and said that he was a pretty good guy. I always wonder what might've happened if we had not bonded over his crazy driving on the icy roads. Or if I would have wanted to go on a second date if all we had done was see a movie and then gone our separate ways, like we had planned. But the snow that day changed my life. My friends were wrong about him; Michael isn't a good guy, he's a great guy. (*laughing)* I know that might sound cheesy but I can't help it. Saying yes to that date might have been the best decision I have made in a long time. I mean, here we are, a year later, still together. *(she pauses, taking a breath)* I've never tried a long-term relation ship before, and it's nice to know that I can. You know? (*She turns back to the scene as he enters.)*

**MICHAEL.** (*He is carrying two mugs of hot chocolate. He hands one to her, then carefully sits down on the couch with his. He takes a sip, then sets the mug on the coffee table.)* I have to hand it to you; I



wouldn't credit everything that happens to snow, but it definitely does seem to make hot chocolate taste fantastic.

**ANNA.** (*She takes a sip of her own, then sits down next to him.)* I'm pretty sure it's not the snow that does it.

**MICHAEL.** (*looking at her in surprise)* Oh? Suddenly you're denying the strength of your all-powerful precipitation?

**ANNA.** (*She hits his arm lightly, scowling)* I mean, it's not snowflakes that make hot chocolate taste good. My secret recipe for hot chocolate mix makes the hot chocolate taste good.

**MICHAEL.** So snow has nothing to do with it? Which means that it wasn't because of the snow that our first date went wonderfully? Which means—

**ANNA.** But of course, if it weren't for the snow, we wouldn't be drinking the hot chocolate.

**MICHAEL.** *(with an exasperated sigh)* Fine. You win.

**ANNA.** *(smug once more)* I always do.

**MICHAEL.** *(After a moment, he takes a deep breath.)* You know what I love?

**ANNA.** *(She leans her head on his shoulder once more, only kind of paying attention.)* Hmm?

**MICHAEL.** *(He pauses, then decides to back out.)* Never mind. It was nothing.

**ANNA.** *(Slightly more interested now, she looks up at him.)* What? What were you going to say?

**MICHAEL.** (*He pauses once more, unsure of himself.)* It's… you. I love you, Anna.

**ANNA.** *(She is taken off-guard, and she sits up straight, staring at him. She does not believe that she heard him right.)* What?

**MICHAEL.** I love you. I have for a while now, and I just didn't know how to say it, or when to say it. I thought that now… with the snow and all… *(He trails off, even less sure of himself. She has stopped looking at him, in shock.)*

**ANNA.** I… Well… Thank you, I guess.

**MICHAEL.** *(He looks as though she slapped him.)* Excuse me?

**ANNA.** I—

**MICHAEL.** Thank you?!

**ANNA.** Well, I—

**MICHAEL.** Thank you? That's all you… (*stopping himself)*

**ANNA.** Michael, I… I'm sorry, I just… I mean, we've only known each other for a year!

**MICHAEL.** Don't.

**ANNA.** Michael, please, I—

**MICHAEL.** Don't! Don't try and make me feel better. I get it. You don't love me.

**ANNA.** Stop being so melodramatic! Real life isn't a soap opera, Michael.

**MICHAEL.** I'm sorry. I didn't realize that I wasn't allowed to be a little upset that the girl I have been dating for a year does not love me.

**ANNA.** Let's talk about this. It's not that I don't love you, I just…

**MICHAEL.** What? You just what?

**ANNA.** I just can't commit to that yet. Love. How can you be so sure that you even love me? Love takes more than a year, Michael!

**MICHAEL.** No. It doesn't. (*He stands and walks back to the window.)* It's been a whole year, Anna. How are you not sure?

**ANNA.** I don't know, I… Love is a huge step. I just don't know if we are ready to go there.

**MICHAEL.** How can you know unless you try?

**ANNA.** You don't understand. I've never had a boyfriend who I even could consider loving before! I need time to-

**MICHAEL.** Time? You've had a year, Anna!

**ANNA.** I know. I'm sorry… I just need to think. You kind of threw this at me, I wasn't expecting…

**MICHAEL.** *(There is a long pause before he answers, and when he does his voice is soft and sad.)* That's the point of a surprise. You aren't supposed to expect it.

**ANNA.** Michael, please… *(He doesn't respond.)* Come here, please. *(He freezes, and after a moment she turns to address the audience.)* There's a funny thing about snowflakes. You try to catch them and hold them, to protect them and preserve their beauty. But the tighter you hold them, the faster they melt. The wonderful moment slips from your fingers, shapeless and just… cold. Snowflakes can't last.

**MICHAEL.** It's snowing pretty hard out. *(His voice is now flat, and she notices.)*

**ANNA.** Michael, come back. Sit down; we need to talk about this.

**MICHAEL.** I should go. The roads must already be pretty bad.

**ANNA.** *(She is growing desperate.)* Michael, stop it!

**MICHAEL.** What? What should I stop doing, Anna? Should I stop ruining your fantasy world? Your perfect world free of commitments and worries, where no one has to take risks? Where no one has to be willing to depend on another person?

**ANNA.** No! It's not like that—

**MICHAEL.** Should I stop loving you?

**ANNA.** No. Please, no. Just come back over here and—

**MICHAEL.** Answer this for me, Anna. Do you love me?

**ANNA.** *(She pauses for a long moment.)* Maybe… I don't know!

**MICHAEL.** *(He nods to himself, smiling weakly.)* Then I'll go and leave you alone.

**ANNA.** Wait, please—

**MICHAEL.** Anna? Call me when you do know. *(He goes to open the door.)*

**ANNA.** Wait! *(Both freeze, Michael reaching towards the door and Anna reaching towards him. Michael turns to address the audience.)*

**MICHAEL.** I knew that I was being unfair, but you have to admit, so was she. We could have had a happy ending! All she had to do was stop me. All she had to do was allow herself to let go and stop being afraid of commitment. All she had to do was say—

(*Anna unfreezes and reaches forward, catching his arm and pulling him back into the room.)*

**ANNA.** I love you, too.

**MICHAEL.** *(He stares at her for a long moment, unsure of whether or not he can believe her.)* Really?

**ANNA.** (*She nods, smiling a little.)*

**MICHAEL.** I mean, you're sure?

**ANNA.** *(She nods again.)* I love you more than snow.

(*His face breaks into a grin and they embrace for a long moment. He tilts his head down to kiss her, but they freeze just before they actually kiss. They stay like that for a moment, both of them with their eyes closed. Slowly, Michael opens his eyes and looks down at her, his expression wistful. He turns to address the audience.)*

**MICHAEL.** *(He is smiling sadly.)* But, not everyone can have their happy ending. That was all she had to do. And she wanted to; I could see it in her eyes. (*He looks away, closing his eyes for a moment, then looks back, directly at the audience.)* But she didn't.

**ANNA.** *(She unfreezes, but instead of reaching for him like before, she crosses her arms. Her expression is pained.)* Goodbye, then.

**MICHAEL.** *(Michael moves back to open the door. He looks over his should at her, an equally pained expression on his face. The next line is uttered softly.)* Goodbye, Anna.

**ANNA.** *(She turns away from the door, but she does not respond. After a long moment she walks slowly to the window and stares out.)*

**MICHAEL.** *(Re-entering the scene, addressing the audience but staying off to the side.)* You know, Anna was right. *(He glances back at her for a moment. She is still looking out the window. When he turns back, she slowly makes her way to the couch and lies down.)* Snow transforms the entire world into a glittering wonderland. When I was driving home, the street was so quiet that you could practically hear the snowflakes hit the ground. Everything looked so clean and new. And then, of course, I ruined that, too.

(*He turns to watch Anna as she sits up groggily, rubbing her eyes. She checks the time, and then seems to remember the night before. She rushes to look out the window.)*

**ANNA.** So much snow… *(As she looks out the window, something seems to catch her eye down the road. She looks more intently, her face worried.)* Police cars… I wonder what…

**MICHAEL.** *(to the audience)* They had not plowed the roads before I left.

**ANNA.** *(still looking out the window)* No…

**MICHAEL.** *(He glances at her, then turns back.)* I made it about four blocks before I lost control of the wheel.

**ANNA.** *(Barely breathing, she continues looking out the window. She says the next line to herself.)* Just because it's a blue truck out there doesn't mean it's…

**MICHAEL.** I was distracted, going too fast… Chasing snowflakes.

**ANNA.** *(whispering]* It can't be him. Please… *(Frantically, she pulls her cell*





*The advertisement at the end of this publication originally appeared on pages 14-15.*

*phone out of her pocket. She dials a number and as it rings she walks slowly back to the couch. When no one answers, the phone slips from her hand and she sits down, face blank.)*

**MICHAEL.** Once they found my body, they called my parents. And fairly soon after that, my mom called Anna to tell her… *(As he is talking, Anna reacts to the ringing phone. She reaches for the phone almost reluctantly, and when she answers her eyes are closed.)*

**ANNA.** Hello?

**MICHAEL.** But as soon as she heard my mom's voice, she knew.

**ANNA.** Oh, hello Mrs. Porter. Have you heard from Michael? He hasn't been answering his… *(Her body sagged slightly as she listened to what Michael's mother said on the phone. She bites her lip to keep from sobbing, and the phone slips from her hand once more.)*

**MICHAEL.** Not everyone can have their happy ending.

**ANNA.** *(She hugs her knees to her chest, and she's breathing quickly.)* I'm sorry.

**MICHAEL.** I didn't.

**ANNA.** I'm so, so sorry.

**MICHAEL.** But I hope that someday, she will.

**ANNA.** *(whispering, looking up to the ceiling)* I love you, too.

**MICHAEL.** She knows how to love. So I know that she will. Someday.

**ANNA.** I did love you. More than snow.

**MICHAEL.** *(He smiles slightly, still watching her.)* Yeah. I know.



# How to Do Nothing…

***by Clint Snyder***

*(Ricky, one of the head managers at MallMart, greets the newest employee and tells him how things work around the store-they don't.)*

Welcome aboard the Mall-mart crew. I'm Ricky, your supervisor, and I'm gonna show you the ropes around here, while having lots of fun doing it. The most important rule here is always look busy. One good rule of thumb is to never put your hands in your pockets. People with their hands in their pockets might look like they're not doing anything. Personally, it helps me to put sharp objects like tacks or knives in my pocket. The scars are like little personal reminders etched into your flesh. If you really wanna get creative put some poisonous animals in there. Nothing says you care about quality quite like than trip to the emergency room. Another important tip is to say "ten-four," to your coworkers and anyone else around you. It makes you seem alert and like you know what you're talking about…ten-four… See what I mean?

Now if a customer ever asks you anything, the only answer you should ever give is, "I'll check in the back." It gives them the impression that you're listening and that you care about they want. For example, if a customer were to ask, "Do you have anymore of these stupid ceramic parrots?" "I'll check in the back." "Where is the bathroom?" " I'll check in the back." "You're not listening to a word I'm saying, I want to speak with your supervisor." "I'll check in the back." It works every time and gives you an excuse to go the break room. If someone catches you in the break room, just say, "I had finished all my work so quickly that I thought I might take the opportunity to clean up the break room." Ten- four.

Now, hypothetically, assume you forgot to eat breakfast and it's still three hours 'til your lunch. What do you do? Take a trip down the cereal aisle. Look here: this box has free gluten in it. I don't know what gluten means, but it's probably German for delicious and uh-oh. *(knocks box over)* Some careless customer has knocked the box all over the floor. Walla! Breakfast is served. You can eat it right off the floor to because your gullible coworkers are actually working and just cleaned the floor. *(laughs to self)*

Your work here is very similar to that of a government employee. You have to do as little work as possible over a period of eight hours, while looking productive doing it. This can get kind of boring. One way to pass the time is to head to the pet department and set up a fighting tank for the beta fish. Take bets on the winner; you'll earn a little extra cash on the side. Our current champion is Jose the Whale. Rumor has it that he was genetically modified at beta shipping yard in Mexico City.

We also have a driving range set up in our sporting goods department. A lot of

times the balls fly over and hit old ladies in the fabrics department. It's a good thing, you know, they usually get some sort of head injury. Then there're less customers to ask you questions.

One of the big hassles of working at MallMart is moving carts to the cart coral in the parking lot. You can, however, easily get rid of this problem by getting rid of the carts. There's a creek in back of the store. Just chuck 'em in there. The beavers have even started making a dam out of all the carts back there. If people get angry and ask you where all the carts are just say, "I'll check in the back." Or tell them they could use the exercise. They seem to respond well to this.

Now let me tell you a tip I learned about the lawn and garden department. You don't have to water plants if they're dead and conveniently the weed killer is right there, too. Once you've accidentally spilled weed killer in every plant the store owns, they'll have to order new ones, which will have been freshly watered by the supplier. You know what looks a lot like an inventory form from a distance? Photocopied Sudoku and crosswords. Get my drift? Ten-four. Just put down random numbers that sound good.

If you get an extra couple hundred boxes of kitty litter, oh well, somebody is gonna come into this store some time and that person will have a lot of cats. Until then, you have another excuse for you to take something into the back. Do you see these gloves? *(holds up hands)* You could hit a lot of dissatisfied customers with gloves like these. And guess where I got them… aisle thirteen. At some stores borrowing company property is frowned upon. Fortunately here is not some places. Here we'll just give you a big old MallMart smile. Our philosophy is "Hey, we do that. too." *(gives a shoulder nudge and wink)* Of course, if you ever want to avoid your co-workers, the best way to do it is by taking a stuffed animal cat, go in the middle of the store, wrap your arms tight and say, "Nice kitty mittens," over and over again. *(demonstrates)* People probably won't talk to you for months… or you'll be committed.

Have you ever seen a forklift full of vinegar collide into an aisle full of baking soda? Well, the result is pretty awesome. Try to make it happen at some point while you're working here. If you really find yourself without something to do, dump a gallon of apple juice outside the bathroom, the reactions are priceless, but nothing compared to the low, low prices we have here at MallMart. Have you seen the price on that TV in electronics? Of course the quality and service at MallMart are nothing compared to Jay Mart- uhhh, I mean, I love MallMart.

Why would I even mention Jay Mart? *(nervous laughter)* I certainly don't work there. It's not like I'm some sort of Jay Mart manager trying to knock out the competition by posing as a supervisor here and giving new employees terrible advice. *(nervous laughter continues)* Because that… that would just, just be ridiculous… uhhh, yeah, so just follow my advice and you'll be a successful MallMart employee in no time. Ummm, you can take the rest of the day off with full pay.



# For My Baby

***by Beatrice Pickens***

**CAITLYN.** *(rubbing her belly)* This is Chelsea. I'll see her soon. I know you're thinking "Why is this mother to be so sad?" *(laughs)* I think the same thing sometimes. My life…my life was so beautiful. Rob was my best friend and my lover and my nightmare.

**ROB.** I love you, Caty.

**CAITLYN.** I know.

**ROB.** I love you more than you will ever know.

**CAITLYN.** I love you, too.

**ROB.** *(coaching)* More than…

**CAITLYN.** …more than you will ever know.

**ROB.** I love you to death.

**AGE 8**

**COACH.** Okay kids, gather round. Nancy, stop bullying Jackie. Nancy, you're lying to me; she does not want to give you her lunch money.

**NANCY.** But coach she said that if I could make her cry…that umm…she would give me her lunch money. I promise she did.

**COACH.** Are your fingers crossed? Are you lying to me? Jackie, did you say that?

**NANCY.** Oh she did? Right, Jackie? *(silence)* Ha, maybe she said something else. *(whisper)* I hate you Jackie.

**COACH.** Okay kids today we are going to play dodge ball.

**KIDS.** Yeah! Dodge ball!!

**COACH.** "A" team will be in the middle of the circle and "B" team will be throwing the balls. Ready, go!

**CAITLYN.** Give me the ball. Come on, hurry up. *(she throws)*

**ROB.** Ha! You missed me.

**CAITLYN.** I need a ball! *(throws)*

**ROB.** You throw like a girl.

**CAITLYN.** I am a girl poopie head. *(throws)*

**ROB.** That was a close one, Caty Baby.

**CAITLYN.** I hate that name. *(throws)*

**ROB.** *(hits him)* OUCH! Coach, Caitlyn Moss hit me in the head on purpose.

**CAITLYN.** I did not, He was calling me names. He called me Caty Baby and said that I throw like a girl.

**COACH.** Caitlyn and Rob, time out five minutes each.

**CAITLYN.** *(laughs)* That was the first time he ever lied to me, and the only time I hit him. Ya know people always say, "The person you hate the

most as a kid will end up being your husband''? But they never tell you to run and hide. They never tell you the signs and how to read them. Do not cross…Yield…STOP.

**AGE 16**

**CAITLYN.** *(reading)* …I think you are so beautiful. I wanted to know if you would be my girlfriend? I'm not like the other guys. I'll take care of you. Promise. Write me back. I love you. Rob—A.K.A. Poopie head. *(smiles)* I love you? He loves me?

**ROB.** Did you have a chance to read my note?

**CAITLYN.** Yes, and yes. I thought it was funny that you said you loved me.

**ROB.** Well, I do. I have since we were kids; I just didn't know how to tell you.

**CAITLYN.** Love's pretty strong.

**ROB.** I know, but that's how I feel.

**CAITLYN.** Well, I'll call you later.

**ROB.** Wait, you can't leave yet. Kiss me.

**CAITLYN.** No, we're in the middle of the hall. I hate that.

**ROB.** *(grabs her arm)* Kiss me. That's what couples do. So just do it; my friends are looking.

**CAITLYN.** That's the point, Rob. I just don't kiss people in the hall in front of everyone.

**ROB.** You're gonna kiss me. What the hell is wrong with you? You're embarrassing me. Don't act so stuck up. I'm gonna pull you to my lips and you're gonna kiss me, or I'll..

**CAITLYN.** You'll what?

**ROB.** Don't talk back. *(They kiss.)*

**CAITLYN.** I never listened to my feelings. I became the best actor you've ever seen.

**BOY 1.** What happened to your eye Caty?

**CAITLYN.** Cheerleading tryouts… I got kicked in the face. *(audience)* I started lying to everyone.

**BROTHER.** Hey sis, why aren't you going to prom? It's going to be the best time ever. You talked about going to prom since you were a kid.

**CAITLYN.** Rob and I just decided we wanted to stay at home. *(audience)* He choked me and told me that ''Only dirty girls go to prom. You're my Caty Baby and I don't want any other guy looking at you.'' He had lost it. It used to be he would keep it private, but he couldn't contain his anger anymore. Then, for the first time he showed everyone the person he is.

**AGE 25**

**ROB.** Yes, I'd like two tickets please.



**CAITLYN.** What are we going to see?

**ROB.** Just wait and you'll see.

**CAITLYN.** Oh there's Lewis from high school. Hi Lewis, how have you been? *(they hug)*

**ROB.** What are you doing?

**CAITLYN.** Lewis this is my boyfriend…

**ROB.** Husband!

**CAITLYN.** Rob.

**ROB.** Get over there and wait for me. *(throws her)* Hey Lewis, did I see you hug my wife? Have you lost your mind? What kind of a man touches another man's wife? *(He punches Lewis.)* Don't ever even look in her direction. *(punches him again)*

**CAITLYN.** What is wrong with you Rob? Lewis, I'm so sorry.

**ROB.** You're sorry? He touched you. He disrespected us.

**CAITLYN.** No, he didn't. He just hugged me.

**ROB.** Did you raise your voice to me? *(beat)* You're right, Caty. Lewis, I'm very sorry for this misunderstanding. I'm sorry if I hurt you in any way. Caty, let's go.

**CAITLYN.** No, I'm going to stay here.

**ROB.** *(whispering)* Get outside, get in the car, and pray that when I come out there I don't kill you. Do you hear me you stupid…*(breathes deep)* Get to the car.

**CAITLYN.** *(at the car)* You have got to stop this Rob… *(he hits her, she is on the ground)*

**ROB.** *(rage)* I have to do what? Are you crazy? Don't you ever talk to me like that in public. Don't you see how much I love you? Don't know what I would to for you? God gave you to me and I will keep you forever.

**CAITLYN.** *(speaking through the tears)* Broken arm, dislocated shoulder, bruises everywhere…told the emergency room we had a car accident and I didn't have my seatbelt on. That day was my first miscarriage. We would drive to different hospitals so that no one hospital would connect the incidents. I didn't even tell him, he might have beat me for losing the baby. I was a prisoner.

**ROB.** You don't need to leave the house. Anything you need I'll supply.

**CAITLYN.** He raped me, beat me, and I lied.

**ROB.** Why is your hair up? I told you like it when you wear your hair down.

**CAITLYN.** I lied for him almost a lifetime. What is wrong with me? He…loves…me. Right?. No, I know he doesn't. Two days ago he came home and told me…

**ROB.** You're getting fat, so I have a girlfriend, Nikki. She's gonna move in with us.

**CAITLYN.** I'm officially dead. He doesn't love me. Now all I have left is this baby.

**ROB.** You throw like a girl. *(as kid)*

**CAITLYN.** I can't…
**ROB.** Caty Baby *(as kid)*
**CAITLYN.** Let her…
**ROB.** I wanted to know if you would be my girlfriend?
**CAITLYN.** Die, too. *(she takes out a knife)*
**ROB.** *(voice)* Whatcha doing Caty?
**CAITLYN.** I have to…for her. *(she stabs her stomach)*
**ROB.** I love you… *(takes the knife)*
**CAITLYN.** …to death. *(he kills her)*



# Reggie Wilson...

***by Christopher Rife***

**REGGIE.** Hi, my name is Reggie. In my little town of Apple Valley, I'm pretty famous. See, I'm the most famous kid detective ever.
**HARRIET.** Don't forget about me! Harriet the Spy!
**REGGIE.** Shut up, Harriet! *(kicks her in the face)*
**HARRIET.** Ahhhh! I shall never sleuth again...
**REGGIE.** Anyway, I have my own business, solving such famous cases as *Who Stole the Cookies from the Cookie Jar* and *Do Chicken Pox REALLY Cause You to Turn into a Chicken*? Yes. Yes, they do. But little did I know that my biggest case was about to arrive. It was lunchtime...
**FENTON.** Reggie, Reggie!
**REGGIE.** That's Fenton. We've been best friends since kindergarten. *(to Fenton)* What seems to be the problem, buddy?
**FENTON.** I think Mr. Bailey is a robot. I mean, it totally makes sense! It's only the first day of fourth grade, and he already gave us homework over the weekend! He doesn't have a heart! And you know what else don't have hearts?
**REGGIE.** Grapes?
**FENTON.** Besides grapes! ROBOTS! And you know I have enough problems with my allergies as it is to go worrying about that robot killing me.
**REGGIE.** OK, I'll do it. I knew this was gonna be a tough case...I was gonna need some help. I needed animal instincts...like that kid in my class who was raised by wolves!
**WOLF CHILD.** Just because I was raised by wolves doesn't make me any different from you guys. *(starts scratching himself and howls)*
**REGGIE.** Maybe not. I needed someone with energy...like that kid with Restless Leg Syndrome!
**RLS KID.** I can't control it! *(legs shaking wildly)*
**REGGIE.** No. I needed someone with smarts. I needed a girl. I needed Susie!
**SUSIE.** Stop! You have reached the girls' lunch table—no boys allowed. You're not allowed to talk to me unless you talk in "girl."
**REGGIE.** Fine... Oh my Gosh, Susie, so here's the 4-1-1. We think Mr. Bailey is, like, a robot.
**SUSIE.** *(laughing)* You cannot be serious, girlfriend.
**FENTON.** We're so…so….so serious. Mr. Bailey shows no emotions. And what else shows no emotions?
**SUSIE.** Grapes.
**FENTON.** Besides grapes! …Robots!
**SUSIE.** I don't know, you guys. You have no evidence. Besides, what's in it for me?
**REGGIE.** *(to audience)* Looks like it was time to use my secret weapon. *(to Susie)* If you help us, I'll give you my Madame Curie trading card.

**SUSIE.** *(looking at the card with awe)* I've always wanted that one. It's the last card I need for the Famous Women Scientists set. Once I have that one, I'll have all three…OK, I'm in, whatever the price.

**REGGIE.** Great! Now, how do we get the evidence we need?

**SUSIE.** Assignment 1: Snooping in his classroom. I'm on it. Assignment 2: Eavesdrop on the teachers' lounge. That's where you guys come in. Assignment 3: *(beat)* There is no assignment three. Now scram.

**REGGIE.** Gotcha. C'mon, Fenton. Let's go.

*(They sneak into the teacher's lounge.)*

**REGGIE.** I pulled out my super high-tech listening device: a glass. *(puts it up to door)*

**MR. BAILEY.** Yes. Yes, dear. I need to stay home tonight. You know…recharge my batteries.

**REGGIE.** Fenton…Mr. Bailey has a battery pack. Like that percussionist rabbit!

**FENTON.** And remember that time when he asked me if I ate Slimy, the class snail? And I said "No." And he said he could see right through me? Only someone with eyes made out of technology could do that! I feel so violated.

**SUSIE.** Psssst. Reggie! Fenton!

**REGGIE.** Susie! Did you find anything?

**SUSIE.** You betcha, boys. I found these CDs on his desk: "Mr. Roboto," "Iron Man," *The Complete Works of Celine Dion*. And I found a piece of paper with his *FULL NAME* on it. Ulysses S. Bailey. His initials are U.S.B. Gentleman, we need to do something drastic.

**REGGIE.** We decided to go to someone who could do something about our problem. *(to Principal)* Principal Wilson! Principal Wilson!

**PRINCIPAL.** Yes, yes. Hold on. I need to send this email to fifteen friends so my crush will call me at midnight and profess their undying love to me. All…right… sent. Oh, hello, Reggie. Are you out solving another case?

**REGGIE.** Yes, sir. That's actually what we came here to talk to you about…

**FENTON.** MR. BAILEY IS A ROBOT! And we have proof! Mr. Bailey doesn't have any feelings! And what else doesn't have feelings?

**PRINCIPAL.** Grapes.

**FENTON.** *(extremely frustrated)* BESIDES GRAPES! *(exasperated)* ROBOTS! He's going to try to use me as a power source for all his diabolic plots. *(crying)*

**PRINCIPAL.** My goodness. If I hired a robot, I've put the children in serious danger…of being left behind! I need to do something about this!

*(He picks up the phone and dials a humorously long number.)*

**PRINCIPAL.** Doris? Would send in Bailey down to my office? Thank you. Alright, Bailey! Your secret is out!

**MR. BAILEY.** What secret?



**PRINCIPAL.** The children here have informed me that you, sir, are a robot. And if we have learned anything from the Salem Witch Trials, it's to always trust the accusations of small children!

**FENTON.** Yeah! *Domo arrigato*, Mr. Roboto!

**REGGIE.** And we heard you saying you needed to go home and "recharge your batteries!"

**MR. BAILEY.** Ha. Ha. Ha. Children, that's only a figure of speech.

**FENTON.** What about how you're speaking, huh?! Explain that!

**MR. BAILEY.** I have a speech impediment.

**SUSIE.** Oh my gosh. We are so…so….so….sorry. Gosh, it must really stink having a speech impediment.

**PRINCIPAL.** I feel awful. You know what? I'm going to give you a raise. Of course, I did just give half the school's budget to that very nice man in Nigeria, though. We'll just cut some more useless art classes from the budget.

**SUSIE.** C'mon Reggie, let's go. It's obvious Mr. Bailey is not a robot. We judged someone we didn't know unfairly. I think the moral here is pretty obvious.

**REGGIE.** I don't know, guys. Something still doesn't seem right… One last question, Bailey: What kind of movie is *The Terminator*?

**MR. BAILEY.** A tragedy due to the unjust persecution of robots.

**REGGIE.** A-ha!

**MR. BAILEY.** Darn.

**REGGIE.** OK, robot! What do you want with us!

**MR. BAILEY.** I only wanted to experience human love.

**PRINCIPAL.** …With little children?!

**MR. BAILEY.** Error. Syntax error. That's wrong. Very, very wrong.

**REGGIE.** Love? So you didn't wanna kill us?

**MR. BAILEY.** I am not programmed to kill. I have been working so hard to try and understand human emotion. It would be a shame to stop now. Is there any way I can stay?

**PRINCIPAL.** Hmm…If we keep a robot on staff, man alive, we'll become the first school in the nation to offer true robotic diversity! Think of the government grants! Alright, Bailey, you're back online!

**MR. BAILEY.** There is this burning sensation inside of me. What is this feeling?

**REGGIE.** Cafeteria food?

**FENTON.** Cooties ?

**PRINCIPAL.** Chlamydia, the adult cooties?

**SUSIE.** No, you guys. It's love! Mr. Bailey, you're experiencing love!

**MR. BAILEY.** Love. Mission accomplished. Thank you, children.

**REGGIE.** *(to audience)* Well, there you have it. Mr. Bailey still teaches at Apple Valley Elementary, but now he's teaching English.

**MR. BAILEY.** "And so the Velveteen Rabbit was taken away from the boy, and they never saw each other again." Tear.

**REGGIE.** The government grants let our school bring back the art and music classes.

**FENTON.** How did I not know about the wonders of the recorder?! *(plays "Hot Crossed Buns")*

**REGGIE.** And Fenton and I are still out solving cases. We even let Susie help us every once in awhile. She's a pretty good detective…for a girl. Luckily for us, there's never a shortage of mysteries in Apple Valley.

**RLS KID.** *(legs still shaking wildly)* HOW DO I MAKE IT STOP?

**REGGIE.** I'm on the case.



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SpeechGeek
806 Brownstone Way
Bowling Green, KY 42104
thegeek@speechgeek.com

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